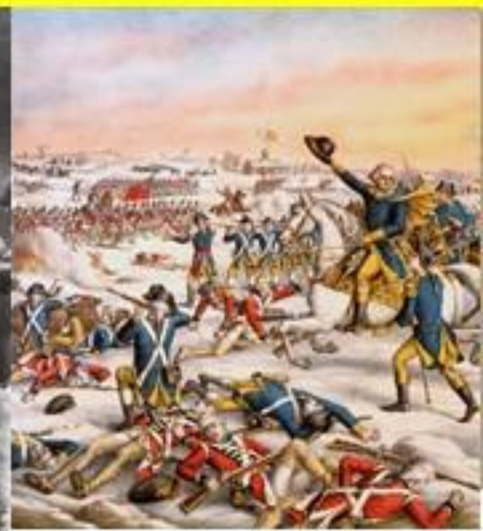


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE - 14

NAPOLEON BONAPARTE

NAPOLEON BONAPARTE

ASCENDENCY OF NAPOLEON

- 1** The changes that France encountered during the revolution which foresee replacement of absolute monarchy by alternative popular arrangements were very novel for the French society.
- 2** Many of the basic problems remained unsolved. People were gradually fed up with the political uncertainty and instability.
- 3** Above all the reign of terror has created pathos in the mind of people.
- 4** The common man in France by the beginning of 19th century wanted peace and order in France.
- 5** The ineffective fiscal policy and the feeble external policy of directory exposed their weakness in front of public.



NAPOLEON BONAPARTE

ASCENDENCY OF NAPOLEON

- 6 The rise in inflation and the devaluation of currency further aggravated the hardship of masses.
 - 7 At this juncture the public of France was willing to get rid of these difficulties even at the cost of some of the ideals of revolution.
 - 8 At the same time brilliant military victory of Napoleon made him the National Hero. people started to look at Napoleon as somebody who can be the panacea for the sufferings of the French public.
 - 9 The policies of the Napoleon at that time fulfilled the aspirations of the various groups of French society.
- 

The **middle class** at this time wanted peace and order.



The **peasantry** wanted to secure the grains they have cultivated so far.



The **counter Revolutionist** wanted to restore back the monarchy.

NAPOLEON BONAPARTE

NAPOLEON AS THE CHILD OF REVOLUTION

- 1** The material conditions for the ascendancy of Napoleon as the Emperor of France were created by the revolution.
- 2** It was impossible for a commoner like Napoleon to even think of sitting on the throne of France while the bourbon kings were ruling France prior to the revolution.
- 3** The revolution ended the absolute monarchy and the privileges of the first two estates.
- 4** The governmental offices after the revolution were to be filled on the basis of merit which earlier used to be the monopoly of the first two estates.
- 5** Based on this merit, capabilities and military valor Napoleon was seen as a national hero this played a crucial role in ascendancy.



NAPOLEON BONAPARTE

NAPOLEON AS THE CHILD OF REVOLUTION

6 Finally the hardships and the sense of insecurity that people faced as the aftermath of revolution during the reign of terror and the ineffective rule of directory, created a void in the politics of France.

7 Napoleon successfully filled this void.

8 Ironically, even though Napoleon can be considered as the child of revolution, yet in some ways his ascendancy reversed the ideals of revolutions.

9 The revolution got triggered with the end of absolute monarchy.

10 However, the rise of napoleon restored the monarchy back in France.



THE CONTINENTAL SYSTEM

1 Napoleon desired to conquer whole world.

2 The biggest hurdle in realization of this dream was the arch rival Britain.

3 Britain maintained a strong navy which France could not match with.

4 The extensive trade links of Britain with different countries was one of the prominent reasons for her being powerful.

5 Napoleon sought to bring England to terms by indirect means, by ruining her trade and commerce upon which her power depended.

6 He envisaged that the closure of every continental market to British goods would be fatal to Britain.



THE CONTINENTAL SYSTEM

7 France declared a blockade of the British Isles and forbidding all commerce with them.

8 All British goods were ordered to be seized.

9 He later also declared that any ship of any country which should touch at a British port, was liable to be seized and treated as a prize.

10 This is called as Napoleon's Continental System.

11 At Tilsit he secured the adherence of Russia to this scheme of destroying England's trade.



EFFECTS OF CONTINENTAL SYSTEM

- 1** Napoleon's Continental system proved more detrimental for France vis-a-vis Britain.
- 2** As the British fleet controlled the seas no colonial goods could be obtained except through British vessels.
- 3** English commerce, though put to enormous disadvantage, went on as it was prior to the arrangement, but that of the continental states under French rule ruined.
- 4** The result was that the prices of the necessities of life went enormously and the greatest sufferers were the inhabitants of the continent.



EFFECTS OF CONTINENTAL SYSTEM

5 As a consequence the subject allies of France became discontented with Napoleon and his rule became hateful to the mass of population.

6 The continental system was one of the great blunders of Napoleon.

7 In order to enforce this system he had to adopt a policy of organized aggression upon on Continental countries which led to the succession of costly wars, exhausting his resources in men and money.



SIGNIFICANCE OF NAPOLEONIC RULE FOR EUROPE

The ascendancy of Napoleon as the Emperor of France proved to be landmark event for France as well as whole Europe.

1 POLITICAL AND ECONOMIC STABILITY

- Before the ascendancy of Napoleon in France the common man in France was in grip of number of hardships.
- The political instability and fiscal imbalances had intensified the sufferings of common man.
- The rule of Napoleon for 13 years i.e., stabilized the economy and peace and tranquility in the country



SIGNIFICANCE OF NAPOLEONIC RULE FOR EUROPE

2 IDEAL REFORMS

- His reforms were guided by the ideals of revolution like equality and fraternity.



3 LIMITED POWERS OF CHURCH

- Napoleon dealt with the pope as a seasoned statesman.
- His concordat with pope in the France satisfied various aspirants and urges of public.
- By this Catholicism was recognized as “religion of great majority of the French people”.
- The Catholic Church was re-established but with limited powers.

SIGNIFICANCE OF NAPOLEONIC RULE FOR EUROPE

4 IDEALS OF REVOLUTION TO OTHER PARTS OF EUROPE

- Napoleon defeated various European countries.
- Therefore, he not just safeguarded the borders of France, but also took the revolution beyond the boundaries.
- During his wars, he propagated the ideals of revolution.



5 REFORMS IN THE SYSTEM

- The rule of napoleon in France initiated a new epoch political, judicial and administrative reforms.
- His Code Napoleon inspired the judicial system of France and other European countries.
- This Code was the greatest contribution of napoleon.



PHASES OF THE REVOLUTION

- 1** The third estate, which constituted about 95-97% of French population and was the chief architect of French revolution, was not a homogenous group.
- 2** Rather, the third estate represented a number of vested interests, under currents and ideologies.
- 3** However, the absolute monarchy and the privileges enjoyed by the first two estates were the common enemies of this third estate.
- 4** The majority of the population in the third estate was that of peasants and artisans i.e., those belonging to lower caste.



PHASES OF THE REVOLUTION

- 5 On the other hand, initially the leadership of the revolution was in the hand of middle class or bourgeoisie leaders and thinkers.
- 6 There were clear cut cleavages in the demands and aspirants of the lower and middle class.
- 7 Lower class envisaged an republican constitution, universal franchise and equitable redistribution of property in the French society.
- 8 In contrast to this middle class envisioned the society based on constitutional monarchy, limited franchise, property rights be legitimized by the state and the government offices to be filled on the basis of merit and not patronage.
- 9 The aspirations and demands of lower class were much radical in nature.



PHASES OF THE REVOLUTION

PHASE	YEAR	STAGE	DETAILS
PHASE I	1789-92	Moderate	Constitutional monarchy, Constitution drafted for France, end of feudal rights and privileges, declaration of rights of man, civil constitution of the clergy, government to be run by elected officials.
PHASE II	1792-95	Radical	Monarchy abolished and republic created, Universal male franchise, king executed for treason, reign of terror by Committee of public safety (Robespierre)
PHASE III	1795-1804	Reaction	Five man Directory created to share power with National Assembly, Moderates regained control.
PHASE IV	1804-15	Napoleonic Era	Napoleon crowned himself as Emperor of France. Some of the ideals of the revolution passed into the oblivion.

WHY DID REVOLUTION OCCUR IN FRANCE BUT NOT ELSEWHERE?

- The contemporary socio-economic and political conditions of the other countries in Europe were no different than France.
- Rather the material well-being of average French men was better than their neighbors.
- The condition of French peasantry at that time was much better than their counterparts in Prussia.
- In France, the political power of the feudal nobility had been hijacked.
- However in other European countries like Germany the nobles possessed enormous authority.
- The monarchs of the countries like Prussia and Russia were equally despotic as their French counterparts so there was nothing exceptional in the character or in the extent of the grievances of the French people.
- Thus a natural question that arises here is then why did revolution occur in France and not elsewhere?



REASONS

REASONS

5 The privileged classes being more or less exempt from taxation, the burden fell all the more heavily on the common people, thus the rich would support who could support the state paid the least, while who were already over burden were crushed with the weight of taxation.

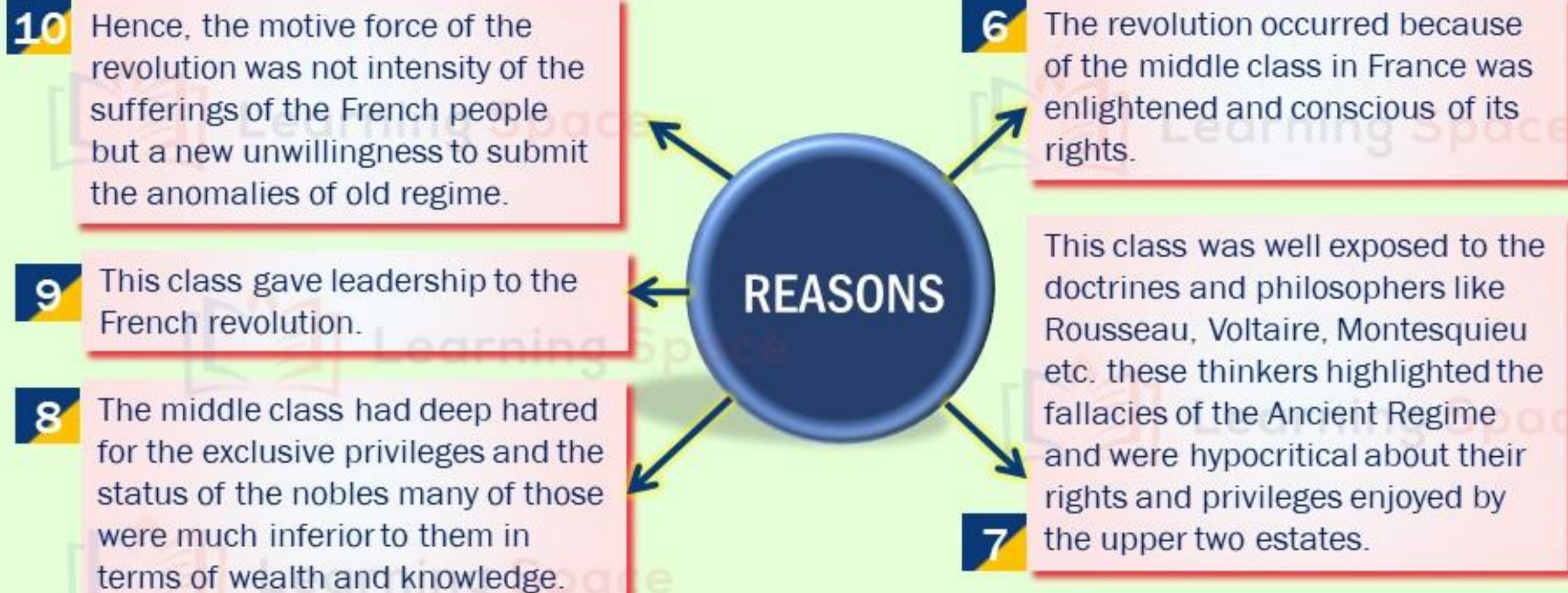
4 The rights and privileges without duties appeared to be unwarranted and irrational.

3 The political power of the French nobility was destroyed much before the French Revolution.

1 It was the inequality and unequal taxation the French society which proved to be the death row for the Ancien Regime in France.

2 In France those belonging the First and Second estates enjoyed certain rights and privileges without corresponding onuses and duties.

REASONS



The Continental System	Desire to conquer whole world-biggest hurdle-Britain-strong navy-closure of every continental market to British goods-blockade of the British Isles
Effects	Detrimental for France-continental states under French rule ruined-prices of the necessities of life went enormously-subject allies of France became discontented with Napoleon
Napoleonic Rule	Political stability-ideals like equality and fraternity-Catholic Church was re-established but with limited powers-propagated the ideals of revolution to other parts of Europe
Revolution-France	Inequality and unequal taxation-First and Second estates enjoyed certain rights-rights and privileges without duties-burden fell on the common people-middle class in France-enlightened and conscious of its rights-doctrines and philosophers-fallacies of the Ancien Regimemotive force of the revolution-new unwillingness to submit the anomalies of old regime.

QUESTIONS FOR PRACTICE

1. Why do you suppose the French people embraced Napoleon as emperor so soon after fighting a revolution that rid them of a king?
150 words
2. "He restored order and brought back prosperity." How far do you agree with this judgment of the domestic policies of Napoleon I during the period between 1799 to 1815?
150 words

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